



GOVERNANCE DOCUMENT

Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct

International Society of Equity Analysts

DOCUMENT VERSION

1.0

DATE APPROVED

1 July 2026

LAST UPDATED

1 July 2026

ADMINISTERED BY

Ethics and Professional
Standards Committee

Document Control

DOCUMENT OWNER	Ethics and Professional Standards Committee
APPROVAL AUTHORITY	Governing Council
ADMINISTERED BY	Ethics and Professional Standards Committee
DATE APPROVED	1 July 2026
LAST UPDATED	1 July 2026
DOCUMENT VERSION	1.0
NEXT REVIEW DATE	1 July 2027
RELATED DOCUMENTS	Ethics Policy Conflict of Interest Policy Membership Regulations Disciplinary Policy Complaints Policy

This document forms part of the official governance framework of the International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) and should be read together with the related documents listed above.

Contents

CODE OF ETHICS	5
1. Commitment to Ethical Professional Conduct	5
2. Integrity of Professional Judgement.....	5
3. Primacy of Investors' Interests.....	5
4. Integrity of Research	5
5. Independence from Improper Influence	5
6. Protection of Market Integrity	6
7. Professional Competence.....	6
8. Responsibility to the Profession.....	6
STANDARDS OF PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT	7
RESEARCH OBJECTIVITY PRINCIPLES	20
9. Research Independence.....	20
10. Protection from Conflicting Interests.....	20
11. Research Disclosure.....	20
12. Recommendations Must Reflect the Member's Actual View	20
13. Rating and Recommendation Integrity	20
DISCLOSURE PRINCIPLES	21
14. Nature of Disclosures	21
15. Research Disclosures.....	21
ENFORCEMENT AND DISCIPLINE	22
16. Personal Responsibility.....	22
17. Breach of the Code.....	22
18. Factors Relevant to Discipline	22
19. Continuing Effect.....	22
20. Interpretation	22
MEMBER'S PROFESSIONAL COMMITMENT	23

PREAMBLE

The integrity of equity research depends upon the quality, independence and honesty of the individuals who produce it.

Equity analysts influence investment decisions by researching companies, interpreting financial information, forecasting performance, assessing value, identifying risks and communicating investment conclusions. The credibility of those activities depends not only upon analytical competence, but upon the Member's independence of judgement and commitment to ethical conduct.

The **ISEA Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct** ("Code") establishes the ethical principles and professional standards expected of every Member and every person who uses an ISEA professional designation.

The Code is intended to protect the integrity of equity research, promote confidence in investment analysis and preserve the reputation of the profession.

They apply to members in all jurisdictions and irrespective of whether a Member works for an investment manager, broker, research provider, family office, private investment organisation, academic institution, independent research practice or other organisation or operates independently.

The Code establishes **personal professional obligations**. Compliance with an employer's policies does not relieve a Member of responsibility under this Code and compliance with this Code does not relieve a Member of any obligation imposed by applicable law or regulation.

Members are expected to exercise professional judgement when applying these provisions to circumstances not expressly contemplated by the Code.

Part I

CODE OF ETHICS

1. Commitment to Ethical Professional Conduct

Members shall uphold the highest standards of professional integrity and exercise sound, independent judgement in the conduct, reporting and publication of equity analysis, investment research and related professional activities.

Members shall avoid conduct that could reasonably be expected to undermine confidence in their professional integrity or the integrity of equity research.

2. Integrity of Professional Judgement

Members shall exercise independent and objective professional judgement.

Personal interests, financial interests, employment relationships, commercial considerations, relationships with issuers or other external parties, compensation arrangements or other influences must not improperly determine a Member's research conclusions or investment recommendations.

3. Primacy of Investors' Interests

Where a Member provides investment research or recommendations for the benefit of investors or clients, the Member shall place the interests of those investors or clients ahead of the Member's personal interests.

For the purposes of this provision, references to investors and clients include prospective investors and prospective clients where the Member is providing research, recommendations or other professional services to them.

Members shall not use professional access, information or influence for the purpose of obtaining an improper personal advantage.

4. Integrity of Research

Members shall strive to ensure that research is:

- based on reasonable and appropriately investigated information;
- analytically rigorous;
- internally consistent;
- materially complete;
- appropriately supported by evidence;
- transparent as to significant assumptions and limitations; and
- presented in a manner that does not mislead the intended reader.

Members shall distinguish clearly between established facts, analytical estimates, assumptions, forecasts, interpretations and opinions.

5. Independence from Improper Influence

Members shall resist pressure from employers, clients, issuers, corporate executives, investment bankers, sales personnel, portfolio managers, investors, media organisations or any other person where that pressure could improperly influence research or investment judgement.

Members shall not knowingly permit another person's interests to determine or materially distort the Member's professional conclusions.

6. Protection of Market Integrity

Members shall conduct themselves in a manner that supports fair, orderly and transparent capital markets.

Members shall not knowingly participate in fraud, market manipulation, deceptive conduct, misuse of confidential information or other conduct that undermines market integrity.

7. Professional Competence

Members shall maintain the knowledge, analytical capability and professional competence reasonably necessary to perform their responsibilities.

Members shall recognise the limits of their expertise and shall not knowingly present themselves as possessing knowledge or competence they do not have.

8. Responsibility to the Profession

Members shall uphold the reputation and standing of the equity research profession by maintaining high standards of professional conduct in their research and professional activities.

Members should encourage ethical conduct by other professionals and should not knowingly facilitate serious professional misconduct.

Part II

STANDARDS OF PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

STANDARD 1 — COMPLIANCE WITH LAW AND PROFESSIONAL OBLIGATIONS

1.1 Compliance with Applicable Law

A Member shall understand and comply with all laws, regulations, industry codes, professional requirements and applicable rules (collectively “applicable requirements”) relating to or affecting, the Member’s professional activities.

Where applicable requirements conflict, the Member shall default to the highest legal or ethical threshold available.

1.2 No Participation in Violations

Members shall not knowingly participate in, facilitate or encourage a violation of law, regulation or professional obligation.

Where a Member becomes aware of serious misconduct, the Member should take reasonable steps to dissociate from the conduct and, where appropriate, report it through an appropriate channel.

1.3 ISEA Requirements

A Member shall comply with:

- the ISEA Charter and other governing documents (including policies);
- the Membership Regulations;
- this Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct;
- applicable disciplinary decisions;
- conditions attached to membership or a professional designation; and
- other mandatory ISEA requirements applicable to the Member.

STANDARD 2 — RESEARCH INDEPENDENCE AND OBJECTIVITY

2.1 Independent Judgement

Members shall maintain independence and objectivity when:

- researching securities;
- analysing companies;
- constructing financial models;
- developing forecasts;
- determining valuation;
- assigning ratings;
- establishing price targets;
- preparing research reports;
- communicating investment views; or
- making investment recommendations.

2.2 Improper Influence

A Member shall not alter, suppress, delay or distort research because of pressure from a person whose interests conflict with the Member’s objective professional judgement.

This includes pressure arising from:

- actual or prospective corporate relationships;
- investment banking or corporate finance activity;
- brokerage relationships;

- compensation arrangements;
- client preferences;
- portfolio positions;
- management relationships;
- personal investments;
- commercial considerations;
- media considerations; or
- the Member's own financial interests.

2.3 Issuer Relationships

A Member may communicate with company management, investor relations personnel, directors, industry participants and other information sources.

Such relationships shall not compromise or reasonably appear to compromise, the Member's independence.

Members shall not allow access to company management, invitations, preferential treatment or other benefits received in a professional capacity to affect the objectivity or conclusions of their research

2.4 Gifts and Benefits

A Member shall not solicit or accept a gift, benefit, hospitality, entertainment or other consideration where the Member reasonably believes that it could compromise or appear to compromise, the Member's independence or objectivity.

The greater the value, frequency or exclusivity of the benefit, the greater the potential conflict.

2.5 Compensation

Members shall not accept personal compensation or other benefits that are contingent upon:

- a particular research conclusion;
- a particular valuation;
- a particular recommendation;
- a particular price target;
- favourable treatment of an issuer; or
- any other outcome that could reasonably compromise professional independence.

STANDARD 3 — RESEARCH QUALITY, DILIGENCE AND REASONABLE BASIS

3.1 Reasonable Basis

Members shall have a reasonable and defensible basis for material conclusions contained in investment research.

3.2 Research Process

Before publishing or communicating a material investment conclusion, a Member should, having regard to the circumstances:

- review relevant financial information;
- understand the company's business model;
- analyse relevant industry and competitive conditions;
- assess historical financial performance;
- develop appropriate forecasts;
- identify material assumptions;
- consider alternative explanations;
- assess relevant risks;

- evaluate appropriate valuation methodologies; and
- investigate information that could reasonably invalidate the investment thesis.

3.3 Contradictory Evidence

A Member shall not knowingly disregard material information merely because it conflicts with the Member's existing investment view.

Material evidence that weakens an investment thesis should be appropriately considered and, where relevant, disclosed.

3.4 Research Limitations

Where a material limitation affects the reliability of the analysis, the Member shall disclose that limitation in a manner reasonably sufficient to allow the intended reader to understand its significance.

3.5 No Requirement of Forecast Accuracy

Members is not responsible merely because a forecast or valuation subsequently proves incorrect.

However, Members remain responsible for ensuring that forecasts, assumptions and conclusions were reasonable and appropriately supported **at the time they were made**.

This distinction is important because future events are inherently uncertain; the objective of professional research is not to guarantee an outcome but to ensure that the analysis has a reasonable and adequate basis.

STANDARD 4 — FINANCIAL ANALYSIS, MODELLING AND VALUATION

4.1 Financial Information

Members shall exercise reasonable care when using financial statements, regulatory filings, company disclosures, market data and other financial information.

4.2 Financial Models

Financial models shall be constructed and maintained with reasonable care.

Material errors, unsupported assumptions, inappropriate methodologies and inconsistencies that could materially affect an investment conclusion shall not knowingly be concealed, obscured or otherwise misrepresented.

4.3 Forecasts

Forecasts shall be based upon reasonable assumptions and appropriate analysis.

Members shall not knowingly manipulate assumptions, estimates or forecast periods to produce a predetermined investment conclusion.

4.4 Valuation

A Member shall select valuation methodologies appropriate to the company and circumstances.

Where a valuation depends materially upon assumptions that are uncertain, subjective or particularly sensitive, the Member should disclose the relevant assumptions and their significance.

4.5 Price Targets and Valuation Ranges

A price target or valuation range shall have a reasonable analytical basis.

Where appropriate, Members should explain:

- the valuation methodology;
- principal assumptions;
- relevant time horizon;
- principal sensitivities;
- catalysts;
- downside risks; and

- circumstances that could invalidate the valuation.

4.6 Scenario and Sensitivity Analysis

Where material uncertainty exists, Members should consider alternative scenarios or sensitivities sufficient to demonstrate how significant changes in assumptions could affect the conclusion.

4.7 False Precision

Members should not present valuation outputs with a degree of precision that is inconsistent with the underlying uncertainty.

STANDARD 5 — RESEARCH REPORTS AND INVESTMENT RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Accuracy and Fair Presentation

Research reports and recommendations shall be presented fairly and shall not knowingly contain materially false, misleading or deceptive statements.

5.2 Fact, Estimate and Opinion

Members shall distinguish appropriately between:

- factual information;
- historical data;
- management statements;
- analyst estimates;
- forecasts;
- assumptions;
- interpretations; and
- investment opinions.

5.3 Investment Thesis

An investment recommendation should identify the principal reasoning supporting the conclusion.

Where relevant, the research should explain:

- the basis for the recommendation;
- valuation;
- expected return;
- investment horizon;
- principal catalysts;
- principal risks; and
- circumstances that could cause the thesis to fail.

5.4 Bear Case and Contrary Evidence

Where material to the investment conclusion, Members should consider and communicate significant factors supporting an adverse investment outcome.

5.5 Changes to Recommendations

A Member shall not knowingly maintain a recommendation that no longer reflects the Member's current professional judgement, such as merely because changing the recommendation would be commercially inconvenient or personally disadvantageous.

Material developments affecting an existing recommendation should be assessed promptly.

5.6 Timeliness

A Member shall take reasonable steps to ensure that research remains current when material developments occur.

Where a previously published recommendation has become materially unreliable or misleading because of a significant development, the Member should issue an appropriate update or otherwise communicate the change.

STANDARD 6 — CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

6.1 Identification

Members shall identify circumstances that could reasonably be expected to impair their independence or create a material conflict between their personal interests and their professional responsibilities.

6.2 Avoidance

Where reasonably practicable, Members should avoid material conflicts that cannot be adequately managed through disclosure.

6.3 Disclosure

Where a material conflict exists, Members shall make full, fair, prominent and understandable disclosure. Disclosure shall be sufficiently specific to allow the intended reader to understand the nature and potential significance of the conflict.

6.4 Personal Securities Holdings

A Member shall prominently disclose in the relevant research or recommendation any personal financial or economic interest in a security that is the subject of the Member's research where that interest could reasonably be expected to influence, or appear to influence, the Member's analysis or recommendation.

This includes direct holdings and relevant derivative or economic interests.

6.5 Family Interests

A Member shall take reasonable steps to identify material financial interests held by persons whose financial interests are sufficiently connected to the Member that they could reasonably affect the Member's objectivity.

6.6 Corporate Relationships

A Member shall disclose relevant relationships with the subject company, including where the Member:

- serves as a director, officer or adviser;
- has a significant consulting relationship;
- receives compensation from the company;
- has another material financial relationship; or
- has another relationship reasonably capable of affecting independence.

6.7 Referral and Other Benefits

Members shall disclose material fees, commissions, referral payments, benefits or other compensation received in connection with recommending an investment, service or product.

STANDARD 7 — PERSONAL TRADING AND INVESTMENT ACTIVITIES

7.1 Personal Trading

Members shall conduct personal investment activity in a manner that does not compromise their research independence, conflict with their professional responsibilities, or create an unfair advantage over persons who rely upon their research or recommendations.

7.2 Trading Against Published Research

A Member shall not knowingly trade personally in a manner materially inconsistent with the Member's published recommendation where the transaction would create a significant conflict or mislead investors regarding the Member's actual professional view.

7.3 Front-Running and Preferential Trading

Members shall not use knowledge of an unpublished recommendation or investment decision to obtain an improper personal advantage.

7.4 Short-Term Trading

Members should avoid frequent short-term trading in securities that they cover where the trading activity could reasonably call their research objectivity into question.

7.5 Material Changes

Where a Member's personal investment position changes in a manner that creates a material conflict with an existing recommendation, the Member shall reassess the recommendation and any required disclosure.

STANDARD 8 — CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION AND INFORMATION SOURCES

8.1 Confidential Information

Members shall preserve confidential information obtained through professional activities unless:

- disclosure is authorised;
- disclosure is required by law; or
- disclosure is otherwise legitimately permitted.

8.2 Material Non-Public Information

A Member who possesses material non-public information shall not improperly use that information for trading, investment recommendations or other personal or professional advantage, nor shall the Member disclose or provide such information to another person for any improper purpose.

8.3 Information Barriers

Where appropriate, Members shall respect information barriers and restrictions established to prevent improper transmission or use of confidential or non-public information.

8.4 Information Sources

Members should assess the reliability and relevance of information sources and should not knowingly present unverified information as established fact.

8.5 Selective Disclosure

Members shall not knowingly exploit selective access to confidential or non-public corporate information in a manner that breaches the law or professional obligations.

STANDARD 9 — DEALINGS WITH COMPANY MANAGEMENT AND CORPORATE SOURCES

9.1 Professional Access

Members may obtain information through engagement with company executives, directors, officers, investor relations personnel, competitors, suppliers, customers, industry specialists and other relevant sources, provided that such access is used responsibly, does not compromise research independence, and is consistent with applicable confidentiality and information-handling obligations.

9.2 No Improper Inducement

Members shall not offer or provide improper benefits or inducement in exchange for favourable, confidential or otherwise inappropriate information.

9.3 Management Representations

Members shall exercise appropriate professional scepticism when evaluating information or representations provided by company management and shall not treat such information as verified fact without reasonable consideration of its reliability and supporting evidence.

9.4 Research Influence

Company management shall not have authority over the Member's final research conclusions merely because the company provides information or access.

9.5 Pre-Publication Review

Where research is shown to a company or other external party before publication for factual verification, the Member shall ensure that such review does not become an opportunity for improper alteration of analytical conclusions.

STANDARD 10 — COMMUNICATIONS WITH INVESTORS AND THE PUBLIC

10.1 Clear Communication

Members shall communicate investment research, analysis, conclusions and recommendations clearly, fairly and objectively and in a manner reasonably appropriate for the intended audience.

10.2 Material Information

Members shall not knowingly omit material information where its omission would make the communication materially misleading.

10.3 Research Methodology

Where relevant, Members should explain the principal methodology, assumptions and analytical framework underlying a recommendation.

10.4 Risks

Members shall clearly and fairly disclose material risks, uncertainties and limitations that could reasonably affect an investment conclusion and shall give such matters appropriate prominence in their research and recommendations.

10.5 Modes of Communication

The principles and standards of this Code apply to Members' professional communications, whether public or private, including:

- written research;
- presentations;
- investor meetings;
- interviews;
- conferences;
- podcasts;
- social media;
- electronic communications;
- websites; and
- other public or private communications.

10.6 Consistency

A Member shall not knowingly communicate a materially different investment view privately from the Member's published recommendation for the purpose of obtaining an improper advantage.

STANDARD 11 — RESEARCH PUBLICATION AND ATTRIBUTION

11.1 Originality

Members shall ensure that research presented as their own represents their own intellectual and analytical contribution.

11.2 Attribution

Material information, analysis, quotations, models, ideas and other substantive contributions obtained from another person, organisation or source should be appropriately attributed.

11.3 Plagiarism

Members shall not reproduce, appropriate or present as their own the research, analysis, investment theses, ideas or other substantive intellectual contributions of another person, organisation or source.

11.4 Third-Party Research

Members may use third-party research where legitimately available, but shall distinguish their own analysis from external analysis and shall not misrepresent third-party conclusions as independent work.

11.5 Research Prepared for Another Purpose

Members shall not present research prepared by an employer, colleague, client or other person as independently authored research where doing so would misrepresent authorship or professional judgement.

STANDARD 12 — TECHNOLOGY, AUTOMATION AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE**12.1 Professional Responsibility**

Members remain personally responsible for the accuracy, integrity, independence and professional judgement reflected in research and recommendations, regardless of the technology used in their preparation.

12.2 Use of Technology

A Member may use spreadsheets, statistical software, financial databases, programming tools, automated systems, artificial intelligence and other analytical technologies, provided their use is consistent with the Member's professional obligations.

12.3 Artificial Intelligence and Automated Outputs

Where artificial intelligence or other automated systems are used in research or analysis, the Member shall exercise appropriate professional oversight and shall not rely upon generated content without reasonable verification of its accuracy, relevance, currency and reliability.

12.4 Accuracy and Reliability

Members shall not take reasonable steps to avoid publishing or communicating:

- fabricated information;
- invented or misrepresented sources;
- unsupported analytical conclusions;
- unverified financial data;
- materially inaccurate information; or
- materially misleading analysis;

including where such information or analysis has been generated, assisted or supplied by an artificial intelligence or other automated system.

12.5 Professional Judgement and Oversight

A Member shall not substitute the output of an artificial intelligence or other automated system for the Member's own professional judgement where the Member is responsible for or represents an investment conclusion as their professional analysis.

12.6 Confidential and Proprietary Information

Members shall not input, upload or otherwise disclose confidential, material non-public or proprietary information to an artificial intelligence or automated system where doing so would breach a legal, regulatory, contractual or professional obligation.

12.7 Attribution and Originality

A Member shall not present AI-generated or AI-assisted research, analysis, ideas or other substantive intellectual contributions as entirely their own where doing so would misrepresent the nature or extent of the Member's contribution or otherwise breach applicable attribution requirements.

STANDARD 13 — RESEARCH RECORDS AND SUPPORTING EVIDENCE

13.1 Records

Members shall maintain appropriate records supporting material research conclusions for a reasonable period having regard to applicable law, regulation and professional requirements.

13.2 Supporting Analysis

Where practicable, records should be sufficient to demonstrate:

- material data relied upon;
- principal assumptions;
- valuation methodology;
- significant analytical calculations;
- material changes to forecasts;
- sources of information; and
- the basis for significant investment conclusions.

13.3 Integrity of Records

Members shall not knowingly fabricate, manipulate, destroy or conceal records for the purpose of misleading investors, employers, regulators or ISEA.

STANDARD 14 — FAIR DEALING AND PROFESSIONAL RELATIONSHIPS

14.1 Fair Treatment

Members shall deal fairly with persons who rely upon their professional research and recommendations, taking into account the nature and terms of the professional services provided.

14.2 Selective Advantage

Members shall not knowingly provide one investor with a material investment recommendation ahead of other investors where doing so would breach an applicable duty or create an improper advantage. This provision does not prohibit differentiated service levels, research access or communication arrangements that are transparently offered and agreed as part of the terms of a professional service.

14.3 Professional Respect

Members shall conduct themselves professionally, courteously and respectfully at all times in their dealings and communications with colleagues, clients, prospective clients, employers, issuers, research subjects, service providers, regulators, other market participants and members of the public.

14.4 Harassment and Discrimination

Members shall not engage in harassment, intimidation, discrimination, bullying or other conduct that is abusive, threatening, degrading or otherwise reasonably likely to undermine the dignity, safety or professional standing of others.

STANDARD 15 — PROFESSIONAL COMPETENCE AND CONTINUING DEVELOPMENT

15.1 Maintenance of Competence

Members shall take reasonable steps to maintain and continually develop the professional knowledge, technical skills and analytical capabilities necessary to perform their professional responsibilities competently and effectively.

15.2 Continuing Professional Development

Where ISEA imposes continuing professional development requirements, Members shall comply with those requirements honestly, accurately and in good faith, including by accurately recording and reporting their professional development activities.

15.3 Areas of Competence

Members should maintain appropriate knowledge of matters relevant to their professional activities, including where applicable:

- financial reporting;
- valuation;
- corporate finance;
- economics;
- financial markets;
- quantitative analysis;
- industry analysis;
- investment risk;
- professional ethics; and
- applicable legal and regulatory requirements.

STANDARD 16 — USE OF ISEA MEMBERSHIP AND DESIGNATIONS

16.1 Accurate Representation

Members shall accurately represent:

- their ISEA membership status;
- their professional designation;
- their qualifications;
- their experience; and
- their relationship with ISEA.

16.2 MISEA and FISEA

The designations **MISEA** and **FISEA** are professional designations of ISEA and may only be used by persons who have been duly admitted to the relevant membership grade and remain entitled to use the applicable designation under ISEA's governing requirements.

Members shall not:

- use **MISEA** or **FISEA** unless duly entitled to do so;
- use a designation after their entitlement has ceased, been suspended or been withdrawn;
- represent or imply that they hold a membership grade or professional standing that they do not hold;
- use **MISEA** or **FISEA** in a manner that is false, misleading or likely to create confusion regarding their qualifications, membership status or professional standing; or
- permit another person to use or represent themselves as holding an ISEA designation when they are not entitled to do so.

Members shall promptly cease using the applicable designation upon ceasing to be entitled to use it.

16.3 No Misleading Association

Members shall not imply that ISEA has endorsed:

- a particular security;
- an investment recommendation;

- an employer;
- a research report;
- a commercial product;
- a service; or
- another person's professional conduct

unless ISEA has expressly provided such endorsement.

16.4 ISEA Reputation

Members shall not knowingly engage in conduct that is materially inconsistent with the ethical and professional standards of ISEA or that is reasonably likely to materially damage the integrity, credibility or reputation of ISEA, its membership or its professional designations.

Members shall not knowingly make false, misleading or materially disparaging statements concerning ISEA, its governance, membership requirements, professional designations, standards or activities.

This provision does not prohibit fair, reasonable or good-faith criticism, disagreement or commentary concerning ISEA or its activities.

Members shall exercise appropriate care when representing, referring to or otherwise associating themselves with ISEA in professional communications, publications, public statements and other forums.

STANDARD 17 — RESPONSIBILITIES TO ISEA

17.1 Truthfulness

Members shall provide ISEA with information that is truthful, accurate, current and complete and shall not knowingly provide information that is false, misleading, outdated or materially incomplete.

17.2 Applications and Assessments

A Member or applicant shall not:

- falsify qualifications;
- misrepresent professional experience;
- submit another person's work as their own;
- conceal material information relevant to eligibility;
- improperly influence an assessment; or
- otherwise compromise the integrity of an ISEA assessment.

17.3 Cooperation

Members shall reasonably cooperate with legitimate ISEA inquiries, investigations and disciplinary processes and shall not knowingly obstruct, mislead or improperly interfere with such processes.

17.4 Confidentiality of ISEA Processes

A Member shall maintain the confidentiality of information obtained through ISEA disciplinary, assessment and other confidential processes and shall not disclose or use such information except where authorised by ISEA, required by law or otherwise necessary for the proper conduct of the Member's professional responsibilities.

17.5 Duty to Maintain Integrity

Members shall not knowingly assist another person in circumventing ISEA membership requirements or professional standards.

STANDARD 18 — PROFESSIONAL MISCONDUCT

A Member shall not engage in conduct involving:

- dishonesty;
- fraud;

- deception;
- plagiarism;
- falsification of research or records;
- fabrication or material misrepresentation of information;
- material manipulation or distortion of research or analysis;
- misuse of confidential or material non-public information;
- market manipulation or other unlawful market conduct;
- serious or undisclosed conflicts of interest;
- corruption, bribery or improper inducements;
- misuse or misrepresentation of ISEA membership, professional designations or affiliation;
- retaliation, intimidation or improper interference in relation to a legitimate complaint, inquiry, investigation or disciplinary process; or
- other conduct that is fundamentally inconsistent with the ethical and professional standards expected of an ISEA professional.

Professional misconduct may occur inside or outside the Member's employment where the conduct is sufficiently connected to the Member's professional integrity, professional responsibilities or use of an ISEA membership or professional designation.

A Member may also be subject to disciplinary action for serious or reckless conduct that materially undermines the integrity of their professional research, analysis or recommendations, even where the conduct does not fall within a specific category listed above.

STANDARD 19 — REPORTING AND ADDRESSING SERIOUS MISCONDUCT

19.1 Responsibility to Act

Members who become aware of credible evidence of professional misconduct shall take reasonable steps to report or otherwise address the matter through an appropriate channel.

19.2 Protection Against Retaliation

Members shall not retaliate against, threaten, intimidate, disadvantage or otherwise treat less favourably a person for making a good-faith report of suspected professional misconduct through an appropriate channel.

19.3 False or Misleading Allegations

Members shall not knowingly make false or misleading allegations of professional misconduct or make allegations for a malicious or improper purpose.

STANDARD 20 — APPLICATION OF THE CODE TO CHANGING PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE

The principles and standards contained in this Code apply to Members regardless of the technology, business model, market structure or method through which equity research is produced, analysed, communicated or distributed.

Members shall apply the principles and standards of this Code to emerging technologies, practices and circumstances, including developments involving:

- artificial intelligence;
- algorithmic analysis;
- alternative data;
- social media;
- digital research platforms;
- automated valuation systems;
- new forms of corporate access;
- novel financial instruments; and

- new methods of producing, communicating or distributing investment research.

A Member shall not rely on the absence of an express provision addressing a particular activity, technology or circumstance as a basis for conduct that is inconsistent with the principles or standards of this Code.

Where the application of this Code to an emerging practice is uncertain, Members shall exercise appropriate professional judgement and act consistently with the underlying ethical principles of the Code.

Part III

RESEARCH OBJECTIVITY PRINCIPLES

9. Research Independence

A Member's investment conclusion shall be the product of the Member's own professional judgement, informed by appropriate research and analysis.

A Member shall not knowingly allow commercial, personal, client, employer, issuer or other external considerations to improperly influence the Member's research, analysis or investment conclusions.

10. Protection from Conflicting Interests

A Member shall identify and appropriately manage circumstances in which:

- the Member owns the security;
- a family member owns the security;
- the Member has a financial interest linked to the security;
- the Member has a relationship with the issuer;
- the Member receives a benefit from the issuer;
- the Member's compensation is influenced by the issuer or recommendation;
- the Member's employer has a commercial relationship with the issuer;
- the Member participates in corporate finance activity involving the issuer;
- the Member is subject to pressure from a client or portfolio manager; or
- another circumstance could reasonably impair objectivity.

11. Research Disclosure

Material conflicts shall be disclosed **prominently, clearly and in plain language**.

Disclosure shall not be designed to obscure, minimise or distract from the conflict.

12. Recommendations Must Reflect the Member's Actual View

A Member shall not knowingly publish or communicate a recommendation that materially differs from the Member's genuine professional assessment merely because another person or commercial consideration favours a different conclusion.

13. Rating and Recommendation Integrity

Where a Member uses a rating system, the rating should be accompanied, where relevant, by sufficient information to allow the reader to understand:

- what the rating means;
- the relevant investment horizon;
- the principal risk considerations; and
- the basis for the recommendation.

Part IV**DISCLOSURE PRINCIPLES****14. Nature of Disclosures**

A disclosure required under this Code shall be:

Material — addressing conflicts and circumstances relevant to the reader's assessment;

Clear — expressed in language that a reasonable reader can understand;

Prominent — not hidden among irrelevant information; and

Specific — identifying the nature of the conflict rather than relying upon generic language.

15. Research Disclosures

Where applicable, a Member's research should disclose material matters including:

- personal ownership or financial interests;
- relevant family financial interests;
- relationships with the subject company;
- material compensation or benefits;
- significant gifts or hospitality;
- relevant external appointments;
- material conflicts of interest;
- valuation methodology;
- significant assumptions;
- principal risks; and
- material limitations affecting the research.

Part V**ENFORCEMENT AND DISCIPLINE****16. Personal Responsibility**

Compliance with this Code is a personal responsibility of every Member.

A Member shall not defend a breach merely by stating that:

- an employer permitted the conduct;
- a supervisor instructed the Member to act;
- another analyst engaged in similar conduct;
- the conduct was common industry practice; or
- the Member was unaware of a requirement that the Member was reasonably expected to understand.

17. Breach of the Code

A breach of this Code may constitute professional misconduct and may result in disciplinary action under the Membership Regulations.

18. Factors Relevant to Discipline

In determining an appropriate disciplinary response, ISEA may consider:

- the seriousness of the conduct;
- whether the conduct was deliberate;
- whether the Member attempted to conceal the conduct;
- whether investors or other persons were harmed;
- the extent of any financial benefit;
- whether the Member cooperated with ISEA;
- whether the Member acknowledged and remedied the conduct;
- whether the conduct was repeated; and
- any other relevant circumstance.

19. Continuing Effect

A Member's obligations under this Code may continue to be relevant after the Member ceases to hold ISEA membership where the conduct occurred during the period of membership or concerns the integrity of an ISEA designation.

20. Interpretation

This Code shall be interpreted consistently with the Membership Regulations and other governing documents.

Where an inconsistency exists between this Code and a higher-ranking ISEA governing document, the higher-ranking document shall prevail.

Nothing in this Code shall be interpreted as limiting any obligation imposed by applicable law or regulation.

Part VI**MEMBER'S PROFESSIONAL COMMITMENT**

Membership of ISEA represents more than the attainment of a professional qualification or the right to use an ISEA designation. It represents a commitment to the integrity of equity research, the responsible exercise of professional judgement and the standards expected of a member of the profession.

Members shall conduct their professional activities in a manner that reflects the principles and standards established by this Code. They shall take responsibility for the quality, integrity, independence and professional basis of their research, analysis and recommendations, and shall exercise appropriate judgement when circumstances are not expressly addressed by a specific provision of the Code.

An ISEA designation represents a professional commitment to conduct that promotes confidence in equity research and the integrity of the profession. Members shall seek to ensure that their research is honestly conceived, independently reasoned, appropriately supported, transparently communicated and prepared with due regard to the interests of those who may reasonably rely upon it.

The standards contained in this Code establish minimum professional obligations. Members are encouraged to aspire to standards of conduct that advance the quality, credibility and reputation of the equity research profession.